



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Blue Whale!

Endangered

Facts • Colour • Activities

Blue Whale Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Balaenoptera musculus
Status:	Endangered
Where they live:	All major oceans — Atlantic, Pacific, Indian, Southern
Habitat:	All the world's oceans — migrates between polar feeding areas and warm tropical breeding grounds
Diet:	Filter feeder — krill (tiny shrimp-like creatures); eats up to 4 tonnes per day
Weight:	Up to 150–170 tonnes
Lifespan:	80–90 years
Population:	Estimated 10,000–25,000 worldwide (recovering after near-extinction)

Amazing Facts ■

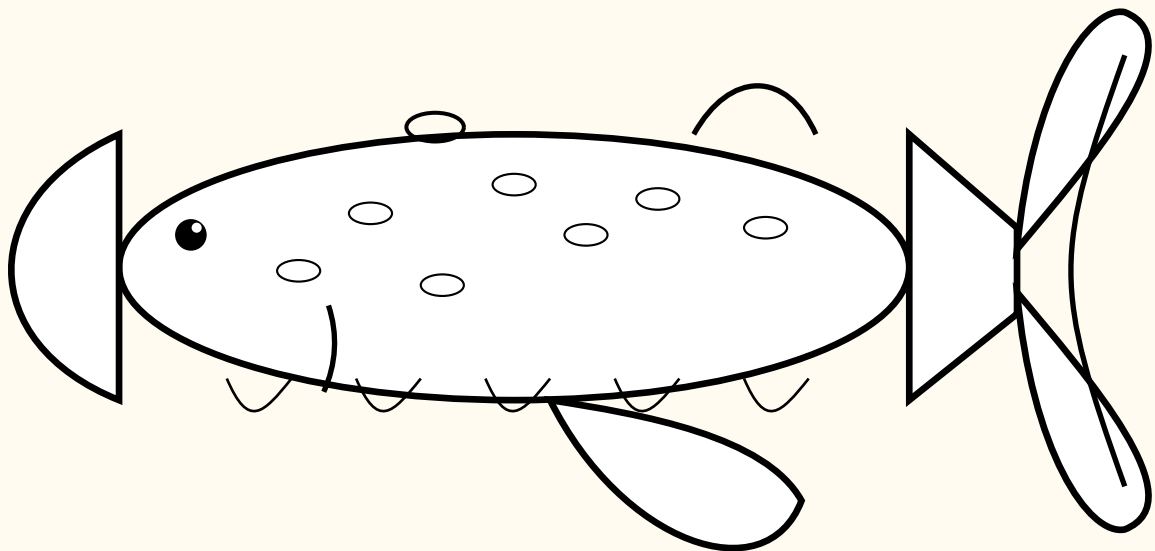
- The blue whale is the largest animal ever known to have lived — bigger than any dinosaur.
- Its heart is the size of a small car and beats just 5–6 times per minute.
- A blue whale's call can be heard up to 1,600 km away — the loudest sound made by any animal.
- Blue whale calves gain around 91 kg (200 lbs) every single day during their first year.
- They can dive to over 500 metres and hold their breath for up to 90 minutes.
- Over 360,000 blue whales were killed by whalers in the 20th century — nearly wiping them out.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Ship strikes	CRITICAL
2	Entanglement in fishing nets	HIGH
3	Ocean noise pollution disrupting communication	HIGH
4	Climate change reducing krill populations	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Blue Whale

Blue whales are blue-grey on top with a mottled lighter pattern. Their underside has a yellowish tinge from tiny organisms.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

O	Z	D	Q	F	D	A	V	D	A	H	J
T	X	B	M	C	I	S	D	U	K	D	M
X	V	H	M	A	E	L	O	Z	E	H	I
Q	B	X	F	Q	M	Y	T	R	F	I	G
K	R	I	L	L	N	M	E	E	O	Q	R
O	W	H	A	L	E	G	A	C	R	M	A
E	Y	B	D	R	N	O	T	L	B	A	T
K	Q	L	T	A	A	O	W	P	G	E	I
H	N	W	D	J	C	R	B	G	H	N	O
Z	U	N	B	D	E	F	Q	N	Q	F	N
P	E	S	Q	F	B	O	C	E	A	N	E
P	F	B	L	O	W	H	O	L	E	F	T

WHALE	OCEAN	KRILL	ENDANGERED
MIGRATION	MAMMAL	BLOWHOLE	FILTER

Match It Up!

Blue whale		largest animal on Earth
Krill		tiny shrimp the whale eats
Blowhole		long journey between oceans
Migration		past hunting that nearly wiped them out
Whaling		how a whale breathes

Fill in the Blanks!

- The blue whale is the _____ animal ever to have lived on Earth.
- Blue whales eat tiny shrimp-like creatures called _____.
- A blue whale's call can be heard _____ km away.
- Blue whales breathe through a _____ on top of their head.

Answers: largest | krill | 1,600 | blowhole

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